OFFICIAL EVIDENCE COLLECTION

Southampton Business opportunity data

Collected for your Business Gap & Opportunity Detector. A searchable reference PDF covering the six document groups in your image.

What is included
Economic indicators, all 28 surveyed centres, population and housing evidence, selected adopted policies, transport information, and 13 regeneration projects. Every table identifies its source and observation period.

No.	Document group	Collected content
01	Economic assessment	Output, enterprises, survival, jobs, earnings and floorspace.
02	Centres study	28-centre vacancy table; 2024 business/operator mix; 2023-24 footfall for six main centres.
03	Local plan / city vision	Adopted-document status, three selected policy provisions, and emerging-plan context.
04	Population / demographics	Census and mid-year estimates, selected wards and clearly dated housing/population forecasts.
05	Transport / accessibility	Published bus corridors, consultation findings, walking-plan scope and planned improvements.
06	Regeneration / investment	Five priority areas and 13 projects with quantities and stages reported in a March 2026 prospectus.

Read the dates alongside the values

This is a collection of published evidence, not a live October 2026 business census. A document updated in 2026 can contain observations from 2021 or 2024. Forecasts and development proposals have their own model or document dates.

The two URLs in your message were joined together. They were separated into the Centres Study page and the Economic Assessment page. Linked Southampton and Hampshire sources were followed to cover the remaining four groups.

Source labels such as E2 p27 or C1 p9 identify a document and its page. Web sources use section headings; all links are listed at the end. Tables reproduce selected factual data, not full source documents.

01 / ECONOMIC ASSESSMENT

Economic performance

Southampton local authority. Sources E1-E2: council assessment updated August 2025. GVA values and growth are at current prices (nominal).

Indicator	Value	Observation	Definition / comparator	Source
Total GVA(B)	£10.0 billion	2023	Rounded; provisional in this release	E2 p8
GVA(B), annual change	+10.6%	2022 to 2023	Change in economic output; not firm revenue	E1
GVA(B) per resident	£38,980	2023	Per head; not earnings or output per worker	E1
GVA(B) per resident, previous value	£35,460	2019	From the same revised series	E1
GVA(B) per resident, change	+9.9%	2019 to 2023	Use this release's historical series	E1
GVA per hour worked	£47.50	2022	UK comparator: £39.70 per hour	E2 p11
Manufacturing share of GVA	16.3%	2023	England: 8.9%; affected by overseas economic ownership	E1
Health and social work share of GVA	14.0%	2023	Industry output share	E1
Transport and storage share of GVA	12%	2023	England: 3%; rounded shares	E1
Public-sector-industry share of GVA	27%	2023	Health, education, public administration/defence; England 19%	E2 p12
Transport and storage GVA change	+£346 million	2021 to 2023	Still £492 million below 2019	E2 p13
Health and social work GVA change	+£327 million	2021 to 2023	Increase in industry output	E2 p13
Manufacturing GVA change	-£453 million	2021 to 2023	Largest decline among industries analysed	E2 p13

What GVA measures
Gross Value Added is economic output after subtracting intermediate inputs. It is not business turnover, household income, profit or a measure of unmet customer demand. Per-resident output is also different from output per worker.

The assessment warns of major historical GVA revisions relating to economic ownership of overseas manufacturing. Use one release consistently when comparing years; nominal increases are not inflation-adjusted growth. [E1: Productivity; E2 pp8-14]

01 / ECONOMIC ASSESSMENT

Business population and survival

These figures describe registered enterprises. They are separate from the retail-unit inventory in the Centres Study.

Indicator	Value	Observation	Definition / comparator	Source
Registered enterprises	7,400	March 2024	VAT and/or PAYE businesses; not a storefront count	E1
Annual change in enterprises	-215 (-2.8%)	2023 to 2024	Snapshot series from UK Business	E1
Micro-enterprise change	-185	2023 to 2024	Fewer than 10 employees	E2 p16
Retail enterprise change	-155	2023 to 2024	Largest decline by enterprise industry	E2 p17
Construction enterprise change	-35	2023 to 2024	Enterprise counts, not job losses	E2 p17
Professional/scientific/technical change	-30	2023 to 2024	Enterprise counts, not job losses	E2 p17
Enterprise density	421 per 10,000	2024	Working-age population; England 653, South East 692	E2 p16
Retail share of enterprises	14%	2024	England: 8%; rounded	E2 p17
Transport/storage share of enterprises	10%	2024	England: 4%; rounded	E2 p17
Professional/scientific/technical share	12%	2024	England: 16%; rounded	E2 p17
Business births	1,005	2023	Business Demography series	E2 p18
Business deaths	1,175	2023	Business Demography series	E2 p18
Birth rate	57.1 per 10,000	2023	Working-age population; England 77.7	E2 p19
Death rate	66.8 per 10,000	2023	Working-age population; England 76.0	E2 p19
One-year business survival	92.3%	2022 birth cohort, to 2023	England: 92.4%; cohort measure	E1
Two-year business survival	68.4%	2021 birth cohort, to 2023	Cohort measure; registration distortions matter	E2 p21
Five-year business survival	33.1%	2018 birth cohort, to 2023	England: 39.4%; includes pandemic period	E1

Sources distinguish the March UK Business snapshot from Business Demography activity during a year. Multiple registrations at individual postcodes affected local births, deaths and survival figures, particularly around 2019-20. Survival rates are specific birth cohorts, not the probability that a proposed new business will succeed. [E1: Business; E2 pp16-22]

01 / ECONOMIC ASSESSMENT

Jobs and labour market

Keep workplace jobs, resident employment, benefit claims and online job advertisements as separate measures.

Indicator	Value	Observation	Definition / comparator	Source
Employee jobs located in Southampton	115,269	2023	BRES; provisional in this source release	E2 p27
Annual employee-job growth	+2,845 (+2.5%)	2022 to 2023	England and South East each +1.3%	E2 p27
Private-sector employee-job change	+2,536 (+3.0%)	2022 to 2023	Separate from sector-industry classifications	E2 p27
Public-sector employee-job change	+309 (+1.1%)	2022 to 2023	Separate from sector-industry classifications	E2 p27
Jobs per working-age resident	0.66	2023	Employee-job density measure in the assessment	E2 p26
Jobs per hectare	23.1	2023	City-wide workplace density	E2 p26
Health-sector employee jobs	27,000	2023	Rounded; about 24% of employee jobs	E2 pp28-29
Education employee jobs	13,000	2023	Rounded industry count	E2 p29
Retail employee jobs	10,000	2023	Rounded industry count	E2 p29
Transport/storage employee jobs	9,000	2023	Rounded industry count	E2 p29
Public administration/defence jobs	6,000	2023	Rounded industry count	E2 p29
Financial/insurance employee jobs	4,000	2023	Rounded industry count	E2 p29
Economically active residents	137,300 (79.2%)	2023/24	Working-age residents; APS estimate	E2 p33
Employed residents	131,900 (76.0%)	2023/24	Working-age residents; APS estimate	E2 p34
Unemployed residents	5,400	2023/24	APS estimate; recent change not statistically significant	E2 p35
Out-of-work benefit claimants	7,910 (4.5%)	February 2025	Working-age residents; not the unemployment rate	E2 p36
Unique job postings rate	344 per 1,000	2024	Working-age population; England 208; Lightcast	E2 p25
Median advertised annual wage	£31,800	2024	Job advertisements; not actual paid earnings	E2 p25

BRES = Business Register and Employment Survey; APS = Annual Population Survey. BRES counts employee jobs; some people hold more than one job. APS figures are estimates with sampling uncertainty. The council does not find all recent labour-market changes statistically significant. [E2 pp26-36]

01 / ECONOMIC ASSESSMENT

Skills, earnings and commercial space

Indicator	Value	Observation	Definition / comparator	Source
Degree-level / RQF4+ qualifications	52.1% (69,100)	2024	Economically active residents; APS; not all residents	E2 p39
RQF3 / A-level-equivalent qualifications	23.5% (31,100)	2024	Economically active residents; APS	E2 p40
No qualifications or RQF1 only	4.0% (5,300)	2024	Economically active residents; APS	E2 p41
Higher-education student enrolments	35,645	2023/24	Southampton institutions; not residents in the city	E2 p43
University of Southampton enrolments	25,995	2023/24	Included in total above; HESA rounded to nearest five	E2 p43
Median gross weekly workplace pay	£716	2024	Full-time workers with jobs in Southampton	E1
Median gross weekly resident pay	£690	2024	Full-time workers living in Southampton	E1
Resident real-pay change	-6.4% (-£47/week)	2021 to 2024	Inflation-adjusted; assessment's calculation	E2 p51
Workplace real-pay change	-8.3% (-£65/week)	2021 to 2024	Inflation-adjusted; assessment's calculation	E2 p51

Business floorspace

Indicator	Value	Observation	Definition / comparator	Source
Total business floorspace change	-17.2%	2000/01 to 2022/23	Stock measure; England +1.7%, South East +4.6%	E2 p23
Office floorspace change	-40.2%	2000/01 to 2022/23	Stock measure; not a vacancy rate	E2 p23
Industrial floorspace change	-24.6%	2000/01 to 2022/23	Stock measure; not a vacancy rate	E2 p23
Industrial share of floorspace	39.5%	2022/23	England: 58.0%	E2 p23
Retail share of floorspace	30.2%	2022/23	Share of total business floorspace	E2 p23

Student enrolments are measured at institutions and are not a count of students resident inside the council boundary. Floorspace change describes property stock, not how much is currently vacant or advertised to let. The questionable total-floorspace unit and contradictory prior-year pay change were excluded; see the quality notes.

02 / CENTRES STUDY

Vacancies in all 28 centres

Unit survey: October-December 2024. Geography: designated centres; City Centre data cover the Primary Shopping Area (PSA).

Centre	Type	Units 2024	Vacant 2024	Rate 2023	Rate 2024	Change pp
City Centre PSA	City	458	61	12.04%	13.32%	+1.28
Shirley*	Town	265	28	10.94%	10.57%	-0.37
Bitterne*	District	98	5	10.89%	5.10%	-5.79
Lordshill	District	16	3	12.50%	18.75%	+6.25
Portswood	District	124	6	6.45%	4.84%	-1.61
Woolston	District	108	9	9.35%	8.33%	-1.02
Aldermoor Road	Local	6	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Bevois Valley Road	Local	30	2	6.45%	6.67%	+0.22
Bitterne Park Triangle	Local	48	1	6.25%	2.08%	-4.17
Burgess Road	Local	31	1	9.68%	3.23%	-6.45
Butts Road	Local	5	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Copperfield Road	Local	3	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Exford Avenue	Local	3	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Hinkler Road	Local	7	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Kendal Avenue	Local	9	1	0.00%	11.11%	+11.11
London Road & Bedford Place	Local	171	16	5.23%	9.36%	+4.13
Maybush	Local	8	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Merryoak	Local	21	0	4.76%	0.00%	-4.76
Midanbury	Local	9	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Portswood Road	Local	13	0	15.38%	0.00%	-15.38
St James Road	Local	11	2	9.09%	18.18%	+9.09
St Mary's Road	Local	38	1	5.26%	2.63%	-2.63
St Mary Street	Local	25	3	4.00%	12.00%	+8.00
Swaythling	Local	46	3	8.70%	6.52%	-2.18
Thornhill Park Road	Local	25	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Weston	Local	4	0	0.00%	0.00%	+0.00
Winchester Road	Local	21	1	0.00%	4.76%	+4.76
Windermere Avenue	Local	8	2	25.00%	25.00%	+0.00

Calculated total across these designated centres: 1,611 units; 145 vacant; 9.00% vacancy. This is not a city-wide inventory of all commercial properties. pp means percentage points.

* Shirley uses 265 units from detailed Tables 10/11 (p16), rather than 237 printed in summary Table 3. Bitterne uses 98 from Tables 14/15 (p20), rather than 93. These detailed totals reconcile to the published vacancy rates. Source: C1 Table 3 pp9-10 and detailed tables.

Small centres are sensitive to one vacancy: Windermere Avenue has 2 of 8 units vacant (25%). Portswood District Centre and Portswood Road Local Centre are different places.

02 / CENTRES STUDY

Business mix by centre

2024 unit counts. Broad Goad use categories, not company industry codes, customer demand or sales. Zero means no surveyed unit in that category.

Centre	Conv.	Cmp.	Retail svc.	Leis.	Fin. / bus.	Com.	Comty	Vac.	Total	Source
City Centre PSA	34	154	52	128	21	5	3	61	458	C1:13
Shirley	35	64	50	59	13	2	14	28	265	C1:16
Bitterne	8	24	22	16	13	0	10	5	98	C1:20
Lordshill	1	2	2	4	0	0	4	3	16	C2:22
Portswood	13	22	20	51	5	0	7	6	124	C1:24
Woolston	7	22	30	28	7	2	3	9	108	C1:26
Aldermoor Road	1	0	2	3	0	0	0	0	6	C1:29
Bevois Valley Road	3	6	4	14	1	0	0	2	30	C2:31
Bitterne Park Triangle	6	7	13	17	0	0	4	1	48	C1:33
Burgess Road	6	0	3	20	0	0	1	1	31	C1:35
Butts Road	1	0	1	3	0	0	0	0	5	C2:37
Copperfield Road	0	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	3	C1:39
Exford Avenue	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	3	C1:41
Hinkler Road	1	2	1	1	0	0	2	0	7	C1:43
Kendal Avenue	1	1	3	2	0	1	0	1	9	C1:45
London Road & Bedford Place	10	13	38	57	28	5	4	16	171	C2:47
Maybush	2	2	3	1	0	0	0	0	8	C2:49
Merryoak	2	4	6	8	0	1	0	0	21	C2:51
Midanbury	1	1	2	5	0	0	0	0	9	C2:53
Portswood Road	4	3	5	1	0	0	0	0	13	C2:55
St James Road	2	1	3	3	0	0	0	2	11	C2:57
St Mary's Road	9	4	7	14	0	2	1	1	38	C2:59
St Mary Street	4	3	4	7	0	0	4	3	25	C2:61
Swaythling	5	8	16	12	0	2	0	3	46	C1:63
Thornhill Park Road	4	5	7	8	0	1	0	0	25	C1:65
Weston	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	4	C2:67
Winchester Road	3	4	8	4	0	0	1	1	21	C2:69
Windermere Avenue	1	2	2	1	0	0	0	2	8	C1:71

Conv. = convenience goods (everyday purchases); Cmp. = comparison goods (non-food shopping); Retail svc. = retail services; Leis. = leisure; Fin./bus. = financial and business services; Com. = commercial; Comty. = community; Vac. = vacant. Categories follow the study classification.

C1:13 means source C1, page 13. C1 identifies the filename ending 24112025. C2 identifies the earlier filename ending 091025; those rows are attributed to that version because the corresponding newer table could not be retrieved. Both describe Autumn 2024; equivalence between versions is not assumed.

02 / CENTRES STUDY

Operator mix by centre

2024 unit counts by operator type, including vacant units. This table describes the same units as the business-mix table; do not add the two tables together.

Centre	National	Regional	Indep.	Comm-unity	Utility	Institut-ion	Vacant	Total	Source
City Centre PSA	237	7	152	1	0	0	61	458	C1:13
Shirley	67	8	151	10	1	0	28	265	C1:16
Bitterne	42	5	36	10	0	0	5	98	C1:20
Lordshill	7	0	2	4	0	0	3	16	C2:22
Portswood	38	8	65	6	1	0	6	124	C1:24
Woolston	16	1	81	1	0	0	9	108	C1:26
Aldermoor Road	2	0	4	0	0	0	0	6	C1:29
Bevois Valley Road	2	0	25	0	0	1	2	30	C2:31
Bitterne Park Triangle	6	1	38	2	0	0	1	48	C1:33
Burgess Road	5	0	25	0	0	0	1	31	C1:35
Butts Road	2	0	3	0	0	0	0	5	C2:37
Copperfield Road	0	0	3	0	0	0	0	3	C1:39
Exford Avenue	2	0	1	0	0	0	0	3	C1:41
Hinkler Road	2	0	3	2	0	0	0	7	C1:43
Kendal Avenue	2	0	6	0	0	0	1	9	C1:45
London Road & Bedford Place	27	8	119	1	0	0	16	171	C2:47
Maybush	3	0	5	0	0	0	0	8	C2:49
Merryoak	6	0	15	0	0	0	0	21	C2:51
Midanbury	3	0	6	0	0	0	0	9	C2:53
Portswood Road	2	0	11	0	0	0	0	13	C2:55
St James Road	0	0	9	0	0	0	2	11	C2:57
St Mary's Road	4	0	31	2	0	0	1	38	C2:59
St Mary Street	1	1	16	4	0	0	3	25	C2:61
Swaythling	5	0	38	0	0	0	3	46	C1:63
Thornhill Park Road	7	1	17	0	0	0	0	25	C1:65
Weston	3	0	0	1	0	0	0	4	C2:67
Winchester Road	1	0	19	0	0	0	1	21	C2:69
Windermere Avenue	1	0	5	0	0	0	2	8	C1:71

Indep. = independent operator. Source version and page appear on each row; C1/C2 have the same meaning as on the preceding page. All business/operator category totals were checked against the printed totals, and 2024 vacancy counts reconcile to the corrected vacancy table.

An independent-heavy centre may be a useful place to investigate local trading needs, but operator mix alone does not establish those needs or an individual business opportunity. This is an analytical use of the data, not a finding of unmet demand.

02 / CENTRES STUDY

Footfall: recorded device activity

The source calls these figures "average visits per day". The method uses WiFi/Bluetooth device signals within 20 metres of a sensor.

Centre	2023 average	2024 average	Reported change	Source
City Centre	16,977	15,349	-9.6%	C1 p12 Table 4
Shirley	7,020	5,337	-24.0%	C1 p15 Table 8
Bitterne*	3,546	2,731	-23.0%*	C1 p19 Table 12
Lordshill	4,102	4,268	+4.0%	C1 p21 Table 16
Portswood	4,324	3,619	-16.3%	C1 p23 Table 20
Woolston*	2,137	1,431	-33.0%*	C1 p25 Table 24

Bitterne and Woolston are not comparable full-year series
Their sensors did not collect data from December 2023 to May 2024. The 2023 averages use January-November; the 2024 averages use June-December. The reported declines above are retained as source values and must not be interpreted as like-for-like annual decreases. [C1 pp19,25]

What these figures can support

They provide a historical activity proxy at the sensor location. For the four centres without the reported outage, changes can be described as the study reports them, while retaining the method and coverage limits. They do not measure unique shoppers, purchases or the entire centre population.

What was not available

The retrieved tables do not provide complete hourly/daily time series, precise sensor locations, a calibration study or a verified unique-device deduplication method. The study did not collect footfall for Local Centres. The city-centre unit boundary is the PSA; the footfall sensor catchment is not established as identical to it. [C1 pp7,12]

Do not rank business success directly from these counts. Different sensor settings, locations, partial periods and customer conversion can affect the relationship between recorded activity and trading results.

03 / LOCAL PLAN

Planning policy and city vision

Selected policy evidence and document status. These are not site-specific planning determinations.

Document	Status / date	Use in your evidence base
Core Strategy	Adopted January 2010; Partial Review adopted 18 March 2015. [PLAN01]	Strategic land use and employment-site policies.
City Centre Action Plan	Adopted 18 March 2015. [PLAN02]	City-centre allocations, place policies and movement priorities.
Emerging replacement Local Plan / City Vision	Emerging. Council relaunch announcement indexed 7 September 2026. [PLAN03]	Store as emerging evidence; no adoption deadline is asserted here.
Growth and Prosperity Plan	Cabinet endorsement 25 November 2025; effective 4 December 2025. [REGEN03]	Overarching economic delivery framework, separate from land-use permission.

Three provisions extracted from adopted documents

Policy	Paraphrased provision	Source
CS7 Employment sites	Safeguards existing employment sites and allocations. Release requires viability evidence or a strong regeneration/suitability case. Waterfront employment and access to jobs in priority areas are relevant considerations.	PLAN01 printed p42
AP24 East Street / Queens Buildings	Supports retail-led mixed use, with residential, hotel and office uses above ground level; addresses active frontages, links towards St Mary's, the park setting and flood safety.	PLAN02 printed p119
AP18 Transport and movement	Promotes an effective city-centre transport network, a shift from car use, and accessible walking, cycling and public-transport provision.	PLAN02 printed p79

These are selected provisions from the 2015 documents. A proposal still needs the applicable adopted policy set, site allocation and current rules checked. Historic use-class wording is not presented as an automatic current permission. The older City Vision timetable is not treated as a current programme.

04 / POPULATION & DEMOGRAPHICS

Population and household demand context

Estimates and Census observations are labelled separately. The figures describe residents and households, not demand for a specific business.

Indicator	Value	Observation / type	Source
Resident population	259,424	Mid-2024 estimate	P01
Male / female residents	128,859 / 130,565	Mid-2024 estimate	P01
Residents aged 0-5	16,359 (6.3%)	Mid-2024 estimate	P01
Residents aged 65+	35,555 (13.7%)	Mid-2024 estimate	P01
Resident population	236,882	Census 2011	P07
Resident population	248,922	Census 21 March 2021	P07
Population growth	+5.1%	Census 2011 to 2021	P07
Population density	49.9 people/hectare	Census 2021	P07
Median age	34 years	Census 2021	P07
Residents aged 20-24	10.5%	Census 2021	P07
Residents aged 5-14	28,288	Census 2021	P07
Households	102,291	Census 2021	P07
One-person households	33,711	Census 2021	P07
Households without a car or van	27.4%	Census 2021	P07

Use one population concept at a time
Mid-year resident estimates, Census counts, GP registrations and future population forecasts describe different concepts and dates. Institution-level student enrolments are also different from students who live in Southampton. Do not combine them as if they were the same population.

The city-wide age 16-24 count and share published on P01 are inconsistent with one another and were excluded. The age 20-24 figure above is a different band from the 2021 Census.

04 / POPULATION & DEMOGRAPHICS

Selected wards and future housing

Selected local population measures

Area	Measure	Period / geography	Source
Banister & Polygon	18,742 residents	Mid-2024; current wards	P01
Harefield	13,585 residents	Mid-2024; current wards	P01
Swaythling	35.9% aged 16-24	Mid-2024; current wards	P01
Banister & Polygon	34.8% aged 16-24	Mid-2024; current wards	P01
Bargate	29.3% aged 16-24	Mid-2024; current wards	P01
Bevois	44.5% of households have no car/van	Census 2021 ward boundary	P07
Bargate	44.2% of households have no car/van	Census 2021 ward boundary	P07

Older forecast retained with its model vintage

2024-based SAPF model	Value / qualification	Source
Resident population, 2026	257,976	P01
Resident population, 2031	269,942 (P02); P01 says 269,941	P01-P02
Population growth, 2026-31	+4.6%	P02
Dwellings, 2026	111,531	P02
Dwellings, 2031	117,306	P02
Dwelling growth, 2026-31	+5.2%; +5,775 calculated from endpoints	P02
Population aged 65+, growth 2026-31	+13.1%	P02

Hampshire now lists a newer 2025-based SAPF model covering 2025-2032, replacing the version above. Newer Southampton values could not be obtained during this collection. The older values are retained as dated evidence, not labelled the latest forecast. [P03]

The council pages state +1,775 dwellings, but 117,306 minus 111,531 is +5,775; the published percentage is consistent with the latter. The one-person disagreement in 2031 population is shown rather than silently reconciled. Current wards and 2021 wards must not be joined by name alone.

05 / TRANSPORT

Transport and accessibility evidence

Published corridor information and consultation findings. These are not shop-level travel-time or accessibility scores.

Bus changes effective 30 August 2026

Service	Published corridor	Published interval
Bluestar 6	Townhill Park - Bitterne - Peartree - Woolston - City Centre	Every 30 min Mon-Sat daytime; hourly Sunday daytime.
Bluestar 16	Bitterne - Northam - City Centre - Central Station - Hill Lane - St James Road - General Hospital - Aldermoor	Every 30 min Mon-Sat daytime; hourly Sunday.
Bluestar 10	Sholing - Bitterne - Northam - City Centre	Hourly daytime.
Bluestar 26	Whiteley - Botley - Hedge End Village - Bitterne - City Centre	Hourly Mon-Sat; every 2 hours Sunday.

Source T05: service-change notice. Routes shown as a corridor summary, not a complete stop list. Published headways describe the announced pattern; they are not live reliability observations.

2023 bus consultation

Published consultation measure	Value
Responses	3,200
More frequent services would encourage more use	65%
Quicker / more direct routes would encourage more use	57%
Stops closer to destinations would encourage more use	39%
Bus was respondents' main transport mode	37%
Most frequent bus purpose: grocery shopping	28%
Most frequent bus purpose: work	27%
Most frequent bus purpose: other shopping	24%

Source T07. Survey ran for three weeks from 23 October 2023. Percentages describe the published respondent results and may relate to different questions; do not add them or interpret them as representative city-wide demand probabilities.

05 / TRANSPORT

Walking and transport investment plans

Walking Improvement Plan scope

The council describes walking audits and potential improvements on routes into the city centre and in six zones: Lordshill, Shirley, Portswood, Bitterne, Woolston and Southampton General Hospital. [T06]

Evidence available	What is still needed for a site-level score
Named walking zones and improvement priorities	Street network, safe crossings, gradients, barriers and step-free conditions.
Published bus corridors and service intervals	Coordinates for stops and premises, full timetables, operating hours and observed reliability.
Census household car availability	Comparable current boundaries and a defined catchment around each candidate location.

Selected BSIP delivery-plan proposals

Proposal	Published scope / target	Source
City Centre bus priority	Proposed changes include 450 m on Commercial Road-Above Bar Street, 290 m on Above Bar Street and a potential 150 m New Road bus-only section; target March 2027.	T04 p1
Portswood corridor	160 m bus-priority and public-realm scheme at Portswood Broadway, subject to trial outcomes; bus-stop improvements; target March 2027.	T04 p1
Shirley corridor	Bus-stop upgrades, information, shelters, access and signal-priority improvements; source target October 2025.	T04 p1
Mass rapid transit development	Feasibility work on a future Southampton Metro / bus rapid transit concept. The table is a planning document, not evidence of an operating metro.	T04 p1

Delivery dates are targets in the source
The 2025-26 delivery-plan dates above do not confirm that work was completed. No point-level walking times, universal-access scores or audited shop catchments were extracted.

06 / REGENERATION & INVESTMENT

Regeneration priorities and pipeline

Renaissance is a council-led investment vision. Project figures below are the stages and quantities reported in the March 2026 prospectus.

Priority area	Stated strategic direction
West Bay	Mixed-use regeneration around the station and waterfront, with innovation and enterprise.
Mayflower Waterfront	Historic waterfront destination, public parkland, homes/workspaces and hospitality.
Itchen Riverside	Connections with Chapel and Northam, sports/entertainment around St Mary’s, and waterfront access.
Heart of the City	Cultural district, Northern Above Bar, East Street and Old Town regeneration.
Ocean Village	Long-term renewal as a waterfront neighbourhood and visitor destination.

Source REGEN01, PDF p9 (printed pp17-18). Its six themes are Waterfront, Destination, Innovation, Neighbourhoods, Green and Connected (PDF p8, printed pp15-16). These are strategic aims.

Projects with quantified housing or commercial space

Project	Reported quantities	Stage in March 2026 source	Source
Bargate Quarter	519 homes; 2,525 m² ground-floor commercial space; £132m reported investment.	Construction underway in the source; opening anticipated in 2026.	R2 p7
Queen's Buildings	607 homes; 420 m² commercial space; two commercial units; 2.7 acres.	Permission in 2022; former department store demolished in 2025.	R2 p9
Town Quay	460 homes; 500+ hotel rooms; 18 serviced apartments; £200m+ reported investment; 1,000 projected jobs.	Resolution to grant subject to a section 106 agreement.	R2 p10
Chapel Riverside	457 homes in total; 300 remaining; 4,963 m² marine employment; 946 m² flexible retail; £100m scheme value.	Some phases complete; two remaining phases for 300 homes consented.	R2 p17

R2 = REGEN02. Quantities are source claims about the scheme or its pipeline, not new observations collected in October. Do not add Chapel Riverside's 300 remaining homes to its 457 total. A conditional resolution is not the same as issued permission.

06 / REGENERATION & INVESTMENT

Further projects and opportunities

Continuation of the March 2026 pipeline snapshot. Quantities called ambitions or opportunities are not delivery commitments.

Project	Reported scale / focus	Stage / qualification	Source
West Bay Innovation District	4.6-acre former Toys R Us site; health, science, engineering and enterprise focus.	New partnership formed January 2026. A 2022 permission concerned an earlier scheme.	R2 p8
West Quay South	About 1,000 homes, 3,000 m² cultural/creative space and 300 hotel rooms; 10 acres.	Council studies; partial Local Plan identification. Indicative opportunity.	R2 p11
West Bay Portside	About 23.5 acres; mixed-use regeneration opportunity.	Leisure World previously consented; wider area remains an opportunity.	R2 p12
Northern Above Bar	Ambition for 220 build-to-rent homes; 1,628 m² ground-floor uses; 435 m² cultural/community uses.	Council studies undertaken.	R2 p13
East Street	Ambition for 400-500 homes and independent food, drink, arts, leisure and retail activity.	Renaissance opportunity area.	R2 p14
St Mary's Waterfront	Sports, entertainment and waterfront regeneration; no quantified output extracted.	Council / football-club memorandum of understanding.	R2 p15
Ocean Village	Renewal as a waterfront neighbourhood and destination; no quantified output extracted.	Landowner studies and masterplanning.	R2 p16
Driver's Wharf	About 20.5 acres; redevelopment ambition.	A large portion is allocated for industrial development.	R2 p18
Southampton Central Station	Source reports £5.5m works completed in 2024; further station improvements under exploration.	Council / Network Rail exploring plans.	R2 p19

These 13 projects across the two pipeline pages should not be summed into a committed housing or investment forecast. They mix completed phases, consented schemes, conditional decisions and early ambitions. The PDF edition is dated from its March 2026 hosting path and metadata; an exact issue date is not printed.

METHOD & DATA GAPS

Using this evidence in your detector

Suggested implementation use below is analysis of the collected material, not an additional council finding.

Question your system can support	Evidence to retrieve	What a defensible output should say
Where were vacancies highest?	C1-C2 centre tables	Name the designated centre, count, rate and 2024 survey period. Note small denominators.
What business mix already exists?	C1-C2 Goad and operator tables	Report categories and counts; confirm current trading status before acting.
Which locations may change through development?	REGEN01-02 plus PLAN01-02	Describe project stage and policy context, with the document date.
Which communities might need particular services?	P01-P03, P07; economic evidence	Describe age/household patterns as demand hypotheses, supported by local validation.
Can people reach a candidate site?	T04-T07; Census no-car data	Explain corridor evidence; identify missing travel-time and accessibility calculations.

Evidence not supplied by these extracted tables

Individual-business revenue or profit; verified business success/failure labels; current rents and leases; complete point-level business inventories; reviews and customer sentiment; willingness to pay; daily transaction data; full footfall time series; site-level journey times; and complete current planning-permission checks.

Minimum metadata to retain with a retrieved fact

Source title and URL; source page/table or web section; document version; observation or forecast period; geography and boundary version; unit and denominator; estimate/observation/forecast/proposal status; and any coverage or quality flag.

Appropriate role for RAG
This evidence can ground answers and explanations in published sources. It does not, by itself, create a labelled training dataset for predicting individual business performance. A high vacancy rate or a large age group is a signal to investigate, not proof of a profitable gap.

QUALITY NOTES

Source checks and limitations

Conflicts are preserved or excluded explicitly. No missing data were filled with invented values.

Issue	Treatment in this PDF
Centres denominators	Summary Table 3 lists Shirley 237 and Bitterne 93 units. Detailed totals of 265 and 98 reconcile to vacancies and published rates; these were used. C1 pp9,16,20.
Centres editions	Thirteen business/operator rows were retrievable only in C2. Each row identifies that earlier official filename. Both versions refer to the same 2024 survey; version equivalence is not asserted.
Benchmark dates	The study's 14.0% national benchmark comes from Local Data Company Q4 2023, although used in the 2024 report. It is not relabelled as a fresh 2024 observation. C1 p9.
Footfall coverage	Bitterne/Woolston compare different months due to sensor failure. Local-centre footfall was not collected. Device activity is not unique shoppers. C1 pp7,19,25.
Economic units and definitions	The inconsistent total-floorspace unit, ambiguous unemployment-rate denominator and conflicting prior-year workplace-pay change were excluded. GVA is nominal. E1-E2.
Population arithmetic	P01 gives a city-wide 16-24 count/share that do not reconcile; both were excluded. P01/P02 dwelling endpoints imply +5,775, not the printed +1,775.
Forecast freshness	2024-based SAPF endpoints are retained with a dated-model label. P03 lists newer 2025-2032 data; its Southampton workbook values were not obtained.
Geography	PSA, designated centres, council wards, Census 2021 wards and the whole local authority are different areas. Names alone are not a valid spatial join.
Plans and delivery	Adopted provisions, emerging plan material, strategy endorsement and project ambitions are distinguished. A future target date is not evidence that delivery occurred.

Access note: many council pages/PDFs returned direct-download blocks. The report uses readable official web text and indexed official tables, and two complete Renaissance PDFs. It does not claim to include full original PDFs, every policy clause, the complete Centres Study appendices or a full export of the interactive dashboards.

CLICKABLE ORIGINAL SOURCES

Source register 1 / 3

All sources accessed or identified on 17 October 2026. A source ID in a data table refers to the entry below. Full URLs are printed for reuse.

E1 | Southampton Economic Assessment - webpage
Last updated August 2025; Council assessment; underlying observations span several years
https://data.southampton.gov.uk/economy/economic-assessment/

E2 | Economic Assessment: Summary of Findings - August 2025
August 2025; download dated 7 August 2025; 59-page council slide set; PDF cover date used despite stale search title '2022'
https://data.southampton.gov.uk/media/iqgh14rf/economic-assessment-august-2025.pdf

C1 | Southampton Centres Study - Autumn 2024 (filename ending 24112025)
Survey October-December 2024. Filename suggests 24 November 2025 version; publication date not independently verified. Printed pages cited.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/media/qsli5vvx/centres-report-2024-24112025.pdf

C2 | Southampton Centres Report 2024 (filename ending 091025)
Earlier filename suggests 9 October 2025 version; publication date not independently verified. Used only for explicitly identified rows.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/media/qsli5vvx/centres-report-2024_091025.pdf

C0 | Centres Study collection page
User-supplied starting page. Official report URLs C1-C2 were used for the numerical extraction.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/planning-building-control/planning/planning-policy/monitoring-and-reporting/centres-study/

CLICKABLE ORIGINAL SOURCES

Source register 2 / 3

All sources accessed or identified on 17 October 2026. A source ID in a data table refers to the entry below. Full URLs are printed for reuse.

P01 | Population size and structure
Updated / issued 2026-06-16. Southampton local authority and selected wards.
https://data.southampton.gov.uk/population/population-size-and-structure/

P02 | Population change
Updated / issued 2026-03-17. Southampton local authority and selected wards.
https://data.southampton.gov.uk/population/population-change/

P03 | Hampshire Small Area Population Forecasts 2025-based source and methodology
New 2025-based SAPF covering 2025-2032; publication date not stated. Hampshire, Portsmouth, Southampton and Isle of Wight.
https://www.hants.gov.uk/landplanningandenvironment/facts-figures/population/estimates-forecasts

P07 | Census 2021 Southampton summary
Updated / issued 2025-07-14. Census observation day: 21 March 2021. Southampton local authority; ward figures use Census 2021 boundaries.
https://data.southampton.gov.uk/population/census-2021/

T04 | Southampton BSIP Delivery Plan 2025-26
Updated / issued 2025. One-page published delivery plan; targets do not establish completion. Southampton city and cross-boundary bus services.
https://transport.southampton.gov.uk/media/3804/2025-2026-bsip-delivery-plan-web.pdf

T05 | Bus Service Improvement Plan webpage and August 2026 service changes
Updated / issued 2026-08-26. Southampton city region.
https://transport.southampton.gov.uk/connected-southampton-2040/bus-service-improvement-plan/

T06 | Southampton Walking Improvement Plan and active travel strategy webpage
Undated webpage. Southampton city.
https://transport.southampton.gov.uk/connected-southampton-2040/our-plans-for-active-travel/

T07 | Bus Service Improvement Plan survey 2023
Undated webpage. Southampton city region survey respondents.
https://transport.southampton.gov.uk/connected-southampton-2040/bus-service-improvement-plan/bsip-survey/

CLICKABLE ORIGINAL SOURCES

Source register 3 / 3

All sources accessed or identified on 17 October 2026. A source ID in a data table refers to the entry below. Full URLs are printed for reuse.

PLAN01 | Core Strategy: amended adopted version (March 2015)
Adopted Core Strategy originally January 2010; Partial Review adopted 18 March 2015. CS7 extracted from printed page 42 of the original adopted version.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/media/io4midh4/amended-core-strategy-inc-cspr-final-13-03-2015_tcm63-371354.pdf

PLAN02 | City Centre Action Plan (adopted 18 March 2015)
Adopted; listed by council among current development plans. AP18 and AP24 extracted from printed pages 79 and 119.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/media/3bidvj1w/ccap-18-march-2015_tcm63-371356.pdf

PLAN03 | Southampton City Vision / emerging Southampton Local Plan
Emerging replacement Local Plan; earlier City Vision draft and consultation evidence must not be labelled adopted policy. Council relaunch announcement indexed 7 September 2026; detailed current timetable not verified.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/news/article/southampton-relaunches-new-local-plan-after-government-reforms/

REGEN01 | Southampton Renaissance: A Prospectus for Change (summary)
First issued February 2025, stated in document. The short PDF contains spreads: PDF p8 corresponds to printed pp15-16, and PDF p9 to printed pp17-18.
https://southamptonrenaissance.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/Southampton-Renaissance_Prospectus_Short_Spreads_accessible.pdf

REGEN02 | Southampton Renaissance: Projects and Opportunities prospectus
R2 in project tables. March 2026 edition inferred from hosting path and PDF metadata (16 March 2026); exact publication date not printed. All cited p-numbers are PDF pages, not spread numbers.
https://southamptonrenaissance.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/03/Southampton-Renaissance_Prospectus_Projects-and-Opportunities.pdf

REGEN03 | Southampton City Council Growth and Prosperity Plan: Cabinet decision
Cabinet endorsed as the council’s overarching approach to growth and prosperity and a framework for its Growing Southampton mission.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/modernGov/%28S%28e1d4nm55zrjf0aarzy0mmjja%29%29/ieDecisionDetails.aspx?Id=3581

REGEN03-PDF | Growth and Prosperity Plan - full source document
Linked for further retrieval. The report uses the Cabinet decision for endorsement status; the full plan was not extracted.
https://www.southampton.gov.uk/media/l4hbuq1q/southampton-growth-and-prosperity-plan.pdf